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C'mon admit it. You have dreamt of a chocolate factory ever since you read Roald Dahl's classic *Charlie and the Chocolate Factory* as a kid. After all, it's quite impossible to resist the allure of all that chocolate. Well, dreams do come true. Head over to Hyderabad's posh Banjara Hills and the Manam Chocolate Karkhana to channelise your inner Willy Wonka.

Launched just a few weeks ago on Independence Day, the Karkhana (factory) is an experiential centre, complete with a chocolate waterfall that wants you to get lost in its world of decadence. From bars, truffles, barks, cookies, brownies, macarons, ice creams and cakes to drinking chocolate and more, Manam, that means 'We' in Telugu, has 45 categories with more than 250 products that range from snacking items to desserts. Think malt chocolate truffles made with 43 per cent malted milk single origin West Godavari chocolate, blueberry dragees (bite-sized confectionary with a hard outer shell) coated in yogurt, creamy white chocolate and toasted sesame or a caramelised cacao nib chocolate brownie made with 82 per cent dark chocolate from single origin Dominican Republic beans.

Set up by Chaitanya Muppala whose family runs a chain of traditional Indian sweets and *namkeen* stores called Almond House in Hyderabad, Manam Chocolates is based on the belief that your chocolates are only as good as your beans. Mup-

pala works with over 100 farmers in the West Godavari region of Andhra Pradesh and has built a new model for cacao processing. "We want to interpret this magical ingredient in every way possible," says Muppala. "We wanted to represent ourselves as Indians without reducing ourselves to the stereotypes of *kesar*, *elaichi*, *badam*," he adds. "The idea behind the Karkhana is to bring the world of premium fine luxury exponential retail to the world of craft, which is typically really small artisanal producers," explains Muppala describing the 10,000 sq. ft space.

While Muppala is probably the latest entrant to the world of craft chocolate (chocolates made from fresh raw cacao beans sourced transparently and turned into chocolates by small-scale chocolate makers) and is manufacturing at a slightly larger scale, he is not the only one. There are several entrepreneurs across the country creating craft chocolate by experimenting with unusual ingredients.

Take for example, Devansh Ashar, who runs the Mumbai-based bean-to-bar brand Pascati. "I started manufacturing chocolate in my bedroom in 2014 after watching a You-



PHOTO BY MANAM CHOCOLATE